



more important than economic development and we are at the forefront of that.

Natural resources are of huge strategic advantage to India. For whatever there is above the ground, there are attractive PLI schemes and India is generally self-sufficient. Now, it is about what lies below the ground, and a lot of that is imported.

I am a geologist by practice, and it is obvious that India has everything—gold, diamonds plus a strong historical background. I understand this since it's the only thing I have done. I started with non-ferrous scrap and then moved to copper smelters, copper rods, before taking over government-owned

“This will be a difficult journey for India, be it on oil and gas or bauxite. At the end of it, we are speaking of brick-and-mortar businesses. We lose foreign exchange in natural resources and that must change”